CHEAT SHEET · DAY 1

Data management I

From the raw LFS file to a clean, documented analysis file. Every command here was taught today; the deck shows each one at work on the LFS or the CPI.

Do-files and logs

Parts 1 and 2

`use "data/file.dta", clear`	open a Stata file
`count`	how many rows
`describe / describe, short`	the variables / the file in four lines
`browse`	look at the data, never edit
`tabulate v`	counts of one variable
`* note / // note`	comments for the reader
`///`	continue a command on the next line
`version 17 / clear all / cd "C:/NBS_Stata"`	the top of every do-file
`capture log close`	close a log left open
`log using "logs/day1.log", replace text`	start the diary
`log close`	end the diary
`help command`	the manual page

Looking inside the file

Part 3

`codebook v`	type, range, missing, the codes
`codebook v1 v2, compact`	one line per variable
`describe dif_*`	every variable starting dif_
`list v1 v2 in 1/5`	the first five rows
`count if v == 2`	how many rows meet a condition
`& | != < >=`	and, or, not equal, less, at least
`... & !missing(v)`	keep missing out of > conditions
`summarize v`	obs, mean, sd, min, max
`bysort g: summarize v`	the same, group by group
`import excel "f.xlsx", firstrow clear`	read an Excel sheet
`import delimited "f.csv", clear`	read a CSV file
`save "data/f.dta", replace`	save the data in memory

Missing values

Part 4

`tabulate v, missing`	show the missing rows
`mvdecode v1 v2, mv(97=.a \ 99=.b)`	codes become missing, with a reason
`codebook v`	read the code labels first
`misstable summarize v1 v2`	how much is missing, of which kind
`assert condition`	stop if a rule is broken
`missing(v) / !missing(v)`	is missing / is not missing

Labels

Part 5

`label variable v "text"`	what the variable means
`label define name 1 "A" 2 "B"`	write a dictionary of codes
`label define name ..., replace / modify`	redo it / add to it
`label define name .a "Don't know", add`	name the missing codes
`label values v name`	attach the dictionary
`label list name`	show a dictionary
`label data "text"`	describe the whole file

New variables

Part 6

`rename old new`	a better name, nothing else changes
`generate v = expression if ...`	a new variable
`replace v = value if ...`	change values of an existing one
`(a == 1)`	true = 1, false = 0
`recode v (a/b = 1) ..., generate(new)`	groups, kept in a new variable
`egen v = count(x), by(g)`	a group count on every row
`egen v = total(x), by(g)`	a group total on every row
`egen v = rowtotal(a b c)`	across variables, missing as 0

Identifiers

Parts 7 and 8

`encode s, generate(n)`	text to labelled numbers
`mdy(m, d, y)`	a date as a day count
`format v %td`	show a day count as a date
`mofd(d) + format %tm`	the month of a date
`isid key`	silent if the key is unique
`duplicates report [key]`	how many copies
`duplicates tag, generate(dup)`	flag the copies
`duplicates drop`	remove exact copies only

Help inside Stata: `help` *command*, and the PDF manual linked at the top of each help page.